

Creating a Basic To-Do App with Node.js

This article is targeted at beginners in Web development. It covers the basics of Node.js, along with a demo on how to use it with the Express Framework to create a basic to-do app.



loop and is the only thread available. The event mechanism helps the server to respond in a non-blocking way and makes it highly scalable, as opposed to traditional servers like Apache which create limited threads to handle requests. Node.js comprises two main components – the core and its modules. The core is built in C and C++. It combines the Google V8 JS engine with Node's Libuv library and protocol bindings, including sockets and HTTP. Node.js is super-fast. All of this sums up the reason why tech giants like eBay, GoDaddy, etc, rely on it for their needs.

While talking about Node.js, we shouldn't forget one of its biggest features – the built-in support for package management using npm. This tool comes, by default, with every Node.js installation. The packages are a set of publicly available, reusable components, available easily with version and dependency management.

So, we are going to try out Node.js by developing a very basic to-do list. In order to do so, you need to have Node.js installed on your local machine.

Node.js is one of the most popular technologies currently. JavaScript, apart from being one of the most popular programming languages on earth, is also very powerful. Node.js, in simple terms, is JavaScript on the server or, maybe, even more than that.

Node.js is used to build scalable and efficient REST APIs. From building hybrid mobile applications to IoT, JavaScript has come a long way from its role in the 90s as the language for flashing images and scrolling messages in your browser.

The main idea of Node.js is to use non-blocking, event-driven I/O to remain lightweight and efficient, which means that the main thread won't be

blocked in I/O operations, and the server will keep attending requests. It is a runtime environment. It does not follow the request/response multi-threaded stateless model. Instead, it follows the single-threaded, event loop model. The event loop is an infinite

```

C:\> npm
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.18362.418]
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D:\Akhil\WIT-AP\New folder\Mag\Node\ToDoApp>npm init
This utility will walk you through creating a package.json file.
It only covers the most common items, and tries to guess sensible defaults.

See `npm help json` for definitive documentation on these fields
and exactly what they do.

Use `npm install <pkg>` afterwards to install a package and
save it as a dependency in the package.json file.

Press ^C at any time to quit.
package name: (todoapp)
  
```

Figure 1: Setting up a new npm package initialiser